

The 7 Infantry Division shoulder patch. (Raffaele Ruggeri)

In order to relieve pressure in the Akhnur sector, India launched its riposte on 6 September. In the Lahore sector, XI Corps (4 Mountain, 7 Infantry and 15 Infantry divisions, plus 2 (Independent) Armoured Brigade) launched Operation *Riddle* with the aim of threatening Lahore, driving a wedge between Pakistani forces deployed in the Lahore and Sialkot sectors and destroying their war potential. The Indian counter-offensives commenced at 0500hrs on 6 September, with 15 Infantry Division advancing along the Amritsar–Lahore axis, 7 Infantry Division along the Khalra–Barkee axis and 4 Mountain Division on the Khem Karan–Kasur axis.

The Indian offensives achieved complete surprise and made good progress initially. Along the Amritsar–Lahore axis, 3 JAT (54 Infantry Brigade) crossed the Ichhogil Canal at Dograi and reached Batapore on the outskirts of Lahore. Indian forces did not exploit their initial success, however. Determined to hold on to their gains despite intense Pakistani shelling, elements of 3 JAT could not endure for long in the absence of reinforcements and anti-tank weapons. By the afternoon of 6 September they had expended most of their ammunition. There was also no hope of any air or artillery support. Unable to replenish or reinforce 3 JAT, Brigadier Maha Singh Rikh, OC 54 Infantry Brigade, ordered the battalion to withdraw.